A1 Education and University Prestige by Audit Firm Tier: Columns 7–9

Variables	(7) GC	(8) MAO	(9) Ln(Fee)
Panel A: Cumulative degree thresholds (base: below bachelor)			
Big 4 audit firm	0.000	0.014	0.348***
	(0.008)	(0.021)	(0.067)
Local 8 audit firm	-0.008*	-0.011*	0.027**
	(0.005)	(0.006)	(0.012)
Bachelor or above	-0.002	-0.002	-0.002
	(0.003)	(0.005)	(0.008)
Master or above	0.001	0.000	-0.003
	(0.004)	(0.006)	(0.010)
Doctorate or above	-0.001	-0.004	0.002
	(0.012)	(0.017)	(0.040)
Big 4 × Bachelor+	-0.005	-0.030	-0.031
	(0.008)	(0.021)	(0.062)
Big 4 × Master+	0.001	-0.002	0.038
	(0.006)	(0.009)	(0.035)
Big 4 × Doctorate+	-0.036	-0.002	0.059
	(0.024)	(0.027)	(0.135)
Local 8 × Bachelor+	0.001	-0.004	-0.010
	(0.005)	(0.007)	(0.011)
Local 8 × Master+	0.004	0.005	0.005
	(0.005)	(0.007)	(0.013)
Local 8 × Doctorate+	-0.008	0.001	-0.064
	(0.014)	(0.021)	(0.046)
Observations	67,594	67,594	62,217
R^2	0.288	0.307	0.847
Client FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Audit firm FE	No	No	No
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes
Panel B: Cumulative university tiers (base: neither 985 nor 211)			
Big 4 audit firm	-0.006	-0.013	0.356***
	(0.006)	(0.008)	(0.041)
Local 8 audit firm	-0.006*	-0.010**	0.018**
	(0.003)	(0.005)	(0.009)
985 or 211 university	0.001	0.003	0.012
	(0.004)	(0.006)	(0.009)
985 university	0.004	0.002	-0.014
	(0.005)	(0.008)	(0.011)
Big 4 × 985/211	0.005	0.003	-0.038
	(0.006)	(0.009)	(0.036)
Big 4 × 985	-0.014*	-0.017*	0.004
	(0.008)	(0.010)	(0.032)
Local 8 × 985/211	-0.004	-0.008	-0.001
	(0.005)	(0.007)	(0.011)
Local 8 × 985	-0.002	0.000	0.000
	(0.007)	(0.009)	(0.014)
Observations	66,613	66,613	61,640
R^2	0.289	0.308	0.847
Client FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Audit firm FE	No	No	No
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes
Controls	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: Robust standard errors clustered by client firm are in parentheses. *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.1$. All specifications include outcome-specific financial controls. Degree and university indicators are cumulative where included. Columns 1–9 absorb client and year fixed effects; column 10 uses client FE as the outcome and absorbs audit firm and year fixed effects.